Juan David Torres

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Interests

Development Economics, Economic History

Education

2023- **Stanford University**
Ph.D. Economics

2019-2020 **Universidad de los Andes**
M.A. Economics

2014-2018 **Pontificia Universidad Javeriana**
B.A. Economics (*Highest Honors*)

Research

Publications

- "Law-Abiding Immigrants: The Incarceration Gap Between Immigrants and the US-born, 1870–2020" (with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, Elisa Jácome, and Santiago Pérez). **American Economic Review: Insights**, Vol. 6, No. 4., December 2024.

Working Papers

- Social Learning and Technological Change: American Agricultural Fairs (September 2025).
- "Bourbon Reforms and State Capacity in the Spanish Empire" (with Giorgio Chiovelli, Leopoldo Fergusson, Luis Martinez, and Felipe Valencia). Revise and Resubmit at **Journal of Political Economy**.
- "Shaping Inequality? Property Rights, Landed Elites and Public Lands in Colombia". (October 2022). Documento Cede 2022-40. Universidad de los Andes.

Honors and Awards

2025 Sean Buckley Memorial Award for Best Second-Year Paper, Stanford University
2020 Master's Thesis Honors, Universidad de los Andes
2019 Xaverian Order of Merit Medal, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana
2019 Highest Department GPA Award, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana
2015-2018 Highest Cohort GPA Awards, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana
2018 National Economics Contest (CANE)

Research Grants

2026 King Center on Global Development Advanced Award, Stanford University (Spring)
2026 SIEPR Schultz Fund Award, Stanford University
2026 Early Stage Dissertation Grant, Economic History Association
2025 Center for Latin American Studies, Stanford University
2025 King Center on Global Development Travel and Exploratory Awards, Stanford University (Spring/Fall)
2023 Research and Innovation Fund, The Pearson Institute, University of Chicago (as Co-PI)
2022 Summer Development Economics Research Fund, BFI, University of Chicago (as Co-PI)
2020 Small Grants in Innovative Data, CIDER, University of British Columbia (as Co-PI)

Conferences and Seminars

2026 Economic History Association Meeting (Poster Session), UCLA Economic History Mini Conference (Poster Session)
2025 Bay Area Economic History Workshop (Berkeley), 3rd Annual Colombian Economics Conference (Uniandes)
2022 Economic History Workshop (Ridge-Uniandes), Workshop on Economic Governance and Legitimacy (Tilburg), Canadian Network for Economic History Conference (Virtual)
2019 Economic History Workshop (Ridge-Montevideo)
2018 1st Annual Colombian Economics Conference (Uniandes), Seminario Banrep

Previous Experience

2024-2026 **Stanford University**
Research Assistant to Melanie Morten
2021-2023 **Stanford University**
Predoctoral Research Fellow to Ran Abramitzky at SIEPR
2020-2021 **Universidad de los Andes/University of Chicago**
Predoctoral Research Assistant to Luis R. Martinez (Chicago Harris) and Nelson Ruiz (Oxford)
2019-2021 **Universidad de los Andes**
Research Assistant to Leopoldo Fergusson (Andes), Felipe Valencia (UBC-VSE), Giorgio Chiovelli (Montevideo) and Luis R. Martinez (Chicago Harris)
2019 **Fedesarrollo**
Research Assistant to Mauricio Cardenas (Columbia SIPA)
2018 **Central Bank of Colombia - Board of Directors**
Research Assistant to Jose Antonio Ocampo (Columbia SIPA)
2017 **Pontificia Universidad Javeriana**
Research Assistant to Paula Herrera-Idarraga
2007-2009 Telenovela Actor

Teaching

2025- **Stanford University**
Intermediate Microeconomics II (Econ 51), Principles of Economics (Econ 1)
2019-2021 **Universidad de los Andes**
Teacher Assistant: Introduction to Colombian Economics, Colombian Economic History
2016-2018 **Pontificia Universidad Javeriana**
Teacher Assistant: Time Series Analysis, Intermediate and Advanced Microeconomics, International Economics, Public Economics

Pre-PhD Research

- "Urban Wage Gaps in Colombia and the Impact of a National Payroll Tax Policy" (with Paula Herrera-Idárraga and Pablo Adrián Garlati). 2021. **Regional Studies**, 1-15.
- "Cambio Estructural y Dinámica Macroeconómica: Los Retos Colombianos". (with José Antonio Ocampo). (2022). In Jose Antonio Ocampo & Maria Fernanda Valdez (Eds.), *Políticas de desarrollo productivo: una agenda para el futuro* (pp. 31-62). Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (FES)
- "El Papel de la Banca de Desarrollo en la Promoción de la Innovación". (with José Antonio Ocampo). (2022). In Jose Antonio Ocampo & Maria Fernanda Valdez (Eds.), *Políticas de desarrollo productivo: una agenda para el futuro* (pp. 223-266). Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (FES)
- "La Banca Nacional de Desarrollo en Colombia" (with Jose Antonio Ocampo and Paola Arias). 2018. **Ensayos sobre Política Económica**, 88, 1-36.
- "Manejo y Resultados de la Bonanza Petrolera" (with Jose Antonio Ocampo) 2018. Economía Colombiana. Edición 353, Agosto-Septiembre de 2018, pp. 80-108.
- "Putting the Eggs in Multiple Baskets: Export Promotion in Colombia During the 1960s". 2018.

Refereeing

Quarterly Journal of Economics

Languages and Skills

Spanish (native), English (advanced)
R, Stata, EViews, LaTeX, Python, ArcGIS, Git, SurveyCTO.

Other Relevant Coursework

Real Analysis, Universidad de los Andes
Latinx Literature, Stanford University